



Renewal of the Current Land Lease Agreement

Background:

Following the previous situational report and operational assessment regarding the current camp location in Al Mawasi - Khan Younis, and due to the continued operational need to maintain the current site, this report is submitted to recommend renewal of the current land lease agreement for an additional one-year period.

Current Operational Importance of the Location:

The current location continues to provide significant operational and humanitarian advantages, including:

- The camp is located within the declared humanitarian zone in Al Mawasi area, where humanitarian operations and displacement movements are currently concentrated.
- The location remains relatively accessible and connected to the main roads used for humanitarian movement and service delivery.
- The site has become recognized by surrounding communities, humanitarian actors, and beneficiary families as a stable and trusted location for SOS operations and child care activities.
- The camp currently hosts children and caregivers making relocation highly sensitive from both operational and protection perspectives.

Existing Investments inside the camp:

As detailed in the previous Situational Report and Operational Assessment related to the current camp location SOS has invested substantial operational and financial resources in the current location during the previous period, including:

- Installation of caravans and tents for children, caregivers, and employees.
- Construction and development of WASH facilities, wastewater systems, and water supply infrastructure.
- Establishment of electricity, internet, and communication networks.
- Preparation of child friendly spaces and activity areas.
- Preparation of administrative offices and storage facilities.
- Implementation of security and safety arrangements within the camp.

Relocation to another site would require significant additional costs and operational efforts to rebuild similar infrastructure and services.

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Market Situation and Alternatives:

During the recent period, the team assessed possible alternatives within the southern area of Gaza. However, the following challenges were identified:

- Very limited availability of suitable land due to the decreasing of the Humanitarian Area.
- Current market rental prices for suitable locations are significantly high and, in many cases, exceed the proposed rental increase.
- Difficulty in identifying alternative locations that can provide similar operational facilities, safety considerations, accessibility, and existing infrastructure within the same rental range.
- Relocation would create disruption to ongoing operations and services provided for children and caregivers.

Rental Increase and Negotiation Process:

SOS PS has been renting the land at a monthly rate of 12,000 USD for 9,160 SM Land since April 2024.

The landowner requested increasing the monthly rental amount to 15,000 \$ plus 1500 ILS for protection services by the landowner per month.

Accordingly, a negotiation committee consisting of the colleagues:

- Wesal Edwan 
- Mohammed Koloub 
- Reem Alreqeb 
- Moreed Zain Eddin 

The committee held several discussions with the landowner in an attempt to minimize the requested increase. However, the owner insisted on the increase due to:

- The continued depreciation of the USD exchange rate against the Israeli Shekel.
- The significant increase in land rental prices within Gaza market conditions during the current period.
- The increasing demand for suitable land within humanitarian areas.

Recommendation:

Based on the above operational, financial, and contextual considerations, and considering the absence of indicators suggesting any expected decrease in rental prices in the near future, it is recommended to:

- Approve renewal of the current camp land lease for one additional year.
- Approve the updated monthly rental amount to 15,000 \$.

This recommendation aims to ensure operational continuity, maintain stability for children and caregivers, avoid unnecessary relocation risks and costs, and sustain uninterrupted implementation of SOS humanitarian and care interventions in Gaza.